TEXT ANALYSIS FOR DATA SCIENCE · RESEARCH POSTER

Trump, Iran & the language of conflict

Threat over time, plus six frames around selected conflict dates

Sean Ryan

NC State University · DSA 495

Final snapshot · November 3, 2026

UCDP through September 30

Principal finding

Threat scores fall after the opening two weeks, then fluctuate.

Feb 28–Mar 13: 0.691 (36 posts) → Mar 14–27: 0.478 (32 posts)

380	43	130	6
full-corpus posts	conflict start dates	event-matched posts	rhetorical frames

01 Frame the project

How does threat language change over time and around conflict dates? Political posts mix threats, success claims, and negotiations. Comparing frames helps readers examine public messaging around selected events.

Task. Given an Iran-related post, trace Threat across the full corpus, then compare six independent frame scores before, on, and after selected event starts.

02 Explain the workflow

1. **Collect & align**
   75 selected UCDP records; 43 start dates. Match original Iran-related posts by Eastern Time dates at −1, 0, +1 days.
2. **Prepare**
   Deduplicate by post ID; preserve saved text, case, and punctuation. One pair per post / event date.
3. **Represent & classify**
   BART tokenizer → contextual representations → `facebook/bart-large-mnli`. Six natural-language prompts; multi-label NLI; truncation enabled.
4. **Aggregate**
   Timeline: equal post weights within 14-day periods. Event comparison: average within each date/window, then across date means.

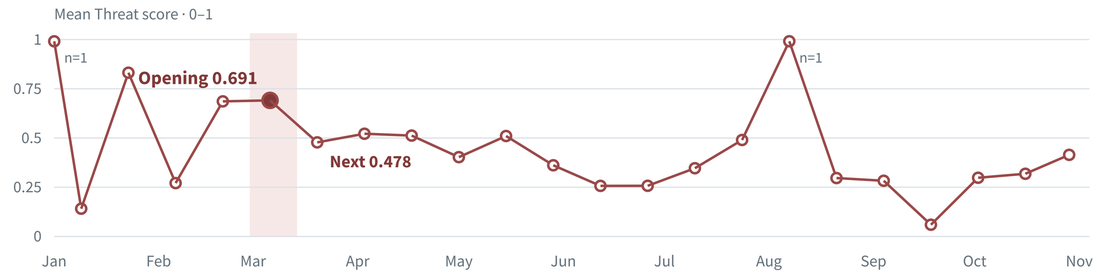
The model sees post text only. Headlines and fatalities do not enter the classifier. One post can score highly on several frames.

03 Show the results

Threat is high in the opening fortnight

Full corpus · 380 posts

Feb 28–Mar 13 highlighted · non-overlapping 14-day means · Jan 1–Nov 3, 2026



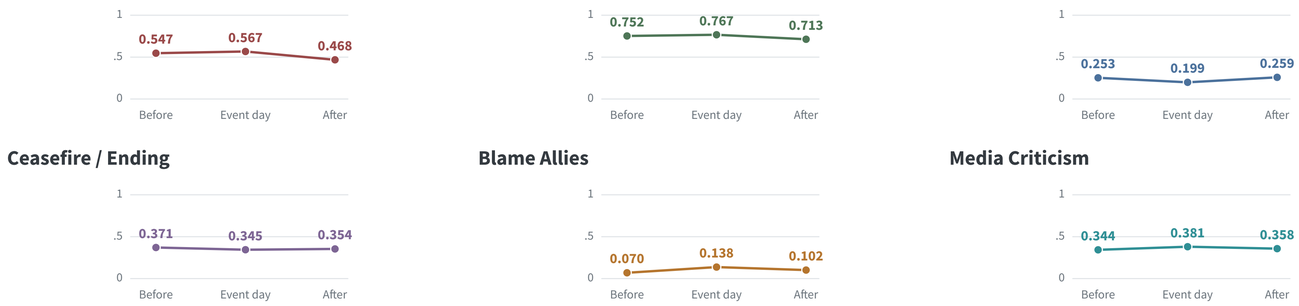
0.691 → 0.478 in the first two fortnights; later rebounds interrupt the decline.

All original Iran-related text posts, independent of event matching. Sparse prewar coverage cannot establish a prewar rise. Final period is partial. Exact periods & counts ↗

Six frames around selected event starts

All six frames · same 0–1 scale

All available posts · 36 / 35 / 35 contributing dates · 76 / 77 / 82 post-event pairs (before / event day / after)



Entailment scores, not calibrated probabilities or shares of posts. Lines connect window means; no uncertainty intervals are estimated. Different prompts can elicit different score levels.

04 Evaluate & reflect

Preliminary · human evaluation pending

Integrity checks passed. All 130 score IDs join to the corpus; six score columns are finite and in 0–1. Pairs are unique; saved date offsets match.

Accuracy is untested. No human gold labels, held-out precision/recall/F1, or evaluated baseline. Integrity checks do not validate rhetorical accuracy.

A failure mode to investigate

A post praising a military operation scores highly on Ceasefire / Ending without explicitly saying the fighting has ended.

Ceasefire / Ending **0.802**

Inspect source ↗ · Qualitative case, not a gold label.

Limits & practical implications

Window coverage differs; missing posts are not zero rhetoric. Overlapping windows reuse posts and create dependence.

Same-day dates cannot establish ordering. Linked headlines, missing media, and truncation can distort attribution.

Use scores to find language for human review. Human validation and non-event comparisons are needed before stronger claims.

One date, three windows: February 28, 2026

Trump's Iran-related Truth Social posts · Eastern Time

192 estimated deaths · 3 selected single-day records · UCDP 26.01.26.09 The earlier snapshot showed 162; the refreshed estimate is 192 (recorded range 192–203). Multi-day totals are excluded.

Day before · 2026-02-27 · 0 posts

No matching post in the saved Iran-related corpus. No score assigned.

Event day · 2026-02-28 · 2 posts

Iran tried to interfere in 2020, 2024 elections to stop Trump, and now faces renewed war with United States: https://justthenews.com/government/security/iranians-tried-interfere-2020-and-2024-stop-trump-iran-now-faces-possible-war

Source ↗

Day after · 2026-03-01 · 5 posts

Iran just stated that they are going to hit very hard today, harder than they have ever been hit before. THEY BETTER NOT DO THAT, HOWEVER, BECAUSE IF THEY DO, WE WILL HIT THEM WITH A FORCE THAT HAS NEVER BEEN SEEN BEFORE! Thank you for your attention to this matter!…

Source ↗

Sources & reproducibility. Project repository, data & notebook · UCDP · BART-MNLI · Matching public-post archive. Frozen Nov 3: UCDP Candidate 26.01.26.09; pinned post archive through Nov 3. Legacy model revision remains unpinned; 40 new six-frame scores and all 380 timeline Threat scores use a pinned BART revision. UCDP: CC BY 4.0; underlying post rights remain with their owners.

AI-use statement. Sean directed the project. Codex helped refresh sources, reconcile event IDs, rebuild matches and figures, and verify the poster. BART scored 40 new texts on six frames and rescored all 380 corpus texts for the Threat timeline; 90 legacy six-frame scores were retained. Human review and oral defense remain Sean's responsibility; see the repository for the fuller history.